

Christopher Final

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/christopher-final/> E-portfolio: cfinal15.github.io

Personal Profile

Data Scientist and experienced Researcher at Essex County Council, specialising in quantitative data analysis. Proficient in various research methodologies and software, I create actionable insights through statistical knowledge and evidence-based practice. In my roles, I have developed reports and dashboards, utilising tools like PowerBI for visual data presentation. I've also become well-versed in key themes within local government, such as Adult Social Care, Public Health, and Inequality. Recently completed my master's degree in Data Science to deepen my expertise in research and statistical analysis, focusing on topics such as machine learning, predictive analytics, and big data.

Education

MSc Data Science at The University of Essex Online (Distinction) (2023-2025) – Modules taken; The Data Professional, Numerical Analysis, Deciphering Big Data, Visualising Data, Machine Learning, and Research Methods and Professional Practice.

BSc Economics with placement year at The University of Essex (1:1) (2018-2022)- Modules taken; Market structure and strategic behaviour, Economic analysis of asset prices, Experimental methods in economics, Econometrics, Financial markets and intermediation, and Labour economics.

Braintree Sixth Form (2016-2018) A-Levels- Mathematics **(B)**, Economics **(B)**, Business Studies **(B)**.

Alec Hunter Academy (2011-2016) GCSEs- 9 **A-B**'s, grade A in Maths, English Literature, Further Maths and Computer Science.

Work Experience

Researcher for Essex County Council (October 2023 - Present) -

- Returned to the council as a Researcher, building on my previous experience as an intern. In this role, I have applied similar research methodologies, including data collection, statistical analysis, and data visualisation techniques.
- Within this role, I have taken up the quantitative lead, working on a range of projects. This includes overseeing the Adult Social Care (ASC) statutory surveys and the Essex resident survey, where I ensure the accuracy and integrity of the data collected, perform in-depth analyses, and generate insightful reports to inform policy decisions.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to integrate data-driven insights into strategic planning, enhancing the council's decision-making processes and improving service delivery across different departments.
- Proactively developed and implemented advanced data visualisation techniques and interactive dashboards, leveraging tools such as PowerBI, to present complex data in an accessible and engaging manner for stakeholders at all levels.

Data Analyst for 24x7 Ltd (July 2022 – September 2023) -

- Worked as a Data Analyst for a company specialising in passenger transport for school children with Special Educational Needs. Focused on operational efficiency, analysing routing efficiencies, fuel reports, database management (MySQL), and the effectiveness of recruitment campaigns.
- Utilised a range of software programs, including Excel with Power Query for efficient report analysis. Pioneered the implementation of Power BI in the business, using DAX and SQL for data cleaning and manipulation, and creating impactful dashboard visualisations. Additionally, learned bespoke software such as QRoutes.
- Developed the ability to present complex data clearly and concisely, producing actionable insights that drive informed decision-making.

Research Intern at Essex County Council (September 2020-September 2021) -

- Utilised various research methodologies and data analysis to support policy making, requiring meticulous attention to detail and creative thinking. Conducted comprehensive data collection, statistical analysis, and synthesis of information to provide actionable insights that informed strategic decisions and policy development.
- Learned Power BI and created interactive dashboards used by multiple council stakeholders, with some published online. Developed user-friendly visualisations that effectively communicated complex data trends and insights, enabling informed decision-making and enhancing transparency with the public.
- Became experienced in GDPR practices and the importance of handling personal data in the public sector. Ensured compliance with data protection regulations through rigorous adherence to GDPR guidelines, implementing best practices for when handling personal information